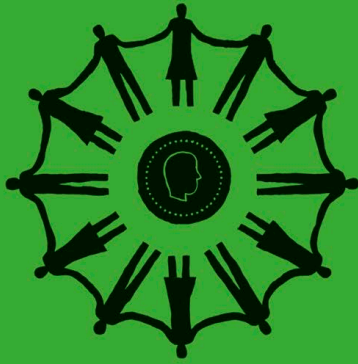




IT'S NOT ABOUT THE MONEY. IT IS ABOUT EQUALITY

EQUAL PAY CERTIFICATION (2017)

IN CONTEXT

FOCUS

Employment law, equal rights

BEFORE

1919 In the US, Michigan and Montana pass equal pay laws.

1951 The UN International Labour Organization's Equal Remuneration Convention states the principle of equal pay for men and women doing work of equal value.

1957 The Treaty of Rome lists equal pay for men and women as a key principle of the EEC.

1963 The Equal Pay Act is introduced in the US.

1975 Women in Iceland go on strike for a day, refusing to work, cook, or care for children.

AFTER

2019 New York governor Andrew Cuomo strengthens the state's 1944 legislation by forbidding potential employers to ask about previous salaries.

In June 2017, the parliament of Iceland passed legislation designed to close the gender pay gap. Like many countries, Iceland had long had equal pay laws, but employers still paid women less than men. The new laws were intended to make sure equal pay actually happened.

The legislation stated that every business in Iceland that employs more than 25 people must obtain a certificate that guarantees its pay

structure complies with equal pay laws. Larger firms had to comply by the end of 2019, and smaller firms between 2020 and 2022.

The change was heralded as a breakthrough for women and led to calls for similar legislation in other countries. But critics insisted the law was unnecessary since Iceland already had laws that guaranteed women equal pay for equal work. They argued that research showing persistent gender wage gaps was

